

How Much Land Does a Man Need?

Leo Tolstoy · 1886

First published: 1886, in Russian; reading text: tr. Louise and Aylmer Maude (1906)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Twenty-three_Tales/How_Much_Land_Does_a_Man_Need? (revision 13888504), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does How Much Land Does a Man Need? suggest about greed?
- What does How Much Land Does a Man Need? suggest about contentment?
- What does How Much Land Does a Man Need? suggest about the devil's temptation?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* How Much Land Does a Man Need?	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*greed* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to How Much Land Does a Man Need?

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Leo Tolstoy's life or times connects to greed in “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (greed, contentment, the devil's temptation).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Leo Tolstoy was born on his family's estate, Yasnaya Polyana, south of Moscow, on 9 September 1828 (28 August, Old Style). After serving in the army in the Caucasus and the Crimean War he wrote War and Peace (1865–69) and Anna Karenina (1875–77). A spiritual crisis in the late 1870s led him to a radical Christianity of non-violence and simple living; he wrote moral tales for ordinary readers, gave up the copyright to many works and was excommunicated by the Russian Orthodox Church in 1901. He died at the railway station of Astapovo on 20 November 1910 after leaving home.

Historical and cultural context

After the emancipation of the serfs in 1861, Russian peasants could buy land, and many sought to acquire more. Tolstoy, a landowner, increasingly condemned private property and greed in his later years.

Publication and reception, then and now

Written and published in 1886 as one of Tolstoy's moral tales for ordinary readers.

Then: Widely read in Russia; James Joyce later called it "the greatest story that the literature of the world knows."

Now: A classic parable about greed.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Pahóm, a peasant, says that with enough land he would not fear the Devil himself. The Devil hears, and Pahóm keeps acquiring more land.

Main themes

- greed.
- contentment.
- temptation.

Why it matters

The parable asks what "enough" means, a question that applies to money, possessions and ambition in any era, and it models how a simple story can carry a moral argument.

Spoilers · teacher only

The Bashkirs offer him all the land he can walk around in a day for 1,000 rubles; he goes too far, races back, and dies at the finish. He is buried in six feet of land.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open How Much Land Does a Man Need?: What does "enough" mean to you?
Prompt: Before we open How Much Land Does a Man Need?: What does "enough" mean to you?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
parable; irony; allegory; foreshadowing.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Leo Tolstoy was born on his family's estate, Yasnaya Polyana, south of Moscow, on 9 September 1828 (28 August, Old Style). After serving in the army in the Caucasus and the Crimean War he wrote War and Peace (1865–69) and Anna Karenina (1875–77). A spiritual crisis in the late 1870s led him to a radical Christianity of non-violence and simple living; he wrote moral tales for ordinary readers, gave up the copyright to many works and was excommunicated by the Russian Orthodox Church in 1901. He died at the railway station of Astapovo on 20 November 1910 after leaving home. The world of the book. After the emancipation of the serfs in 1861, Russian peasants could buy land, and many sought to acquire more. Tolstoy, a landowner, increasingly condemned private property and greed in his later years. Publication and reception. Written and published in 1886 as one of Tolstoy's moral tales for ordinary readers. Then: Widely read in Russia; James Joyce later called it "the greatest story that the literature of the world knows." Now: A classic parable about greed.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed" slowly and put it in my own words: After all his struggle for land, Pahom needs only six feet for a grave. Next, craft. I notice the exact, small measurement, set against the huge stretches of land he wanted. The strongest word is "Six": the plain number answers the title's question with grim exactness. Then, effect. What is the irony of this ending sentence? My answer: The answer to "how much land does a man need" is only enough for a grave; Tolstoy turns the story into a parable against greed.

> *Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed" slowly and put it in my own words: After all his struggle for land, Pahom needs only six feet for a grave. Next, craft. I notice the exact, small measurement, set against the huge stretches of land he wanted. The strongest word is "Six": the plain number answers the title's question with grim exactness. Then, effect. What is the irony of this ending sentence? My answer: The answer to "how much land does a man need" is only enough for a grave; Tolstoy turns the story into a parable against greed.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Pahóm, a peasant, says that with enough land he would not fear the Devil himself. The Devil hears, and Pahóm keeps acquiring more land. Themes to track: greed.: contentment.: temptation.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: greed. Prediction: the peasant Pahom, who says that with enough land he would not fear the Devil, will be tested by that boast. Question: how much land will ever be enough for him?
Task: Set up a reading journal for How Much Land Does a Man Need?: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: greed. Prediction: the peasant Pahom, who says that with enough land he would not fear the Devil, will be tested by that boast. Question: how much land will ever be enough for him?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does How Much Land Does a Man Need? still matter? The parable asks what "enough" means, a question that applies to money, possessions and ambition in any era, and it models how a simple story can carry a moral argument.
Anchor question: Why might How Much Land Does a Man Need? still be taught today?
Facilitation: The parable asks what "enough" means, a question that applies to money, possessions and ambition in any era, and it models how a simple story can carry a moral argument.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Tolstoy, a wealthy count with an estate at Yasnaya Polyana, turned against private property in the 1880s and wrote this story in 1886 as a simple tale for Russian peasant readers. How might that belief shape this story? Answer: Accept answers such as: the story warns against wanting more land; it reads like a moral parable for ordinary Russian readers; Tolstoy's own rejection of property shapes Pahom's fate.
Exit ticket: Tolstoy, a wealthy count with an estate at Yasnaya Polyana, turned against private property in the 1880s and wrote this story in 1886 as a simple tale for Russian peasant readers. How might that belief shape this story?
Answer: Accept answers such as: the story warns against wanting more land; it reads like a moral parable for ordinary Russian readers; Tolstoy's own rejection of property shapes Pahom's fate.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: How Much Land Does a Man Need?.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Leo Tolstoy" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Leo-Tolstoy); Leo Tolstoy, Twenty-Three Tales (tr. Louise and Aylmer Maude) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The Joyce quotation is often cited from a 1935 letter; confirm against the source before quoting.

Lesson 2: How Much Land Does a Man Need?

Focus: greed that grasps more than a person needs

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (death from exhaustion, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Death from exhaustion. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…w the Evil One may tempt your husband with cards, wine, or women, and all will go to ruin. Don…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes death from exhaustion.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Peasant Pahóm boasts that with enough land he would fear not even the Devil, who overhears. Pahóm buys land, then more, always wanting more. The Bashkirs offer as much land as he can walk around in a day for a thousand rubles, if he returns by sunset. He walks too far, runs back, reaches the starting point at sunset and falls dead. His servant digs a grave six feet long: all the land he needed.

Background: Written 1886. Translation: Louise and Aylmer Maude, Twenty-Three Tales (1906), public domain in the US. The Bashkirs are a Turkic people of the southern Urals.

Significance: A widely taught parable; James Joyce reportedly called it the greatest story in world literature.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do you know when you have enough? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to greed because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes death from exhaustion.
Prompt: How do you know when you have enough?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to greed because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: each gain brings only dissatisfaction.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: haggled — argued over a price; disparaged — spoke of something as having little worth; burdening — weight down with a load; freehold — land owned outright; glistened — be shiny, as if wet. "disparaged": Origin of "disparage": Old French desparage. "glistened": From Old English glisnian "to gleam," a Germanic word related to glitter and gleam. (Not from Latin tenere.)
Words: haggled: argued over a price · disparaged: spoke of something as having little worth · burdening: weight down with a load · freehold: land owned outright · glistened: be shiny, as if wet

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Written 1886. Translation: Louise and Aylmer Maude, Twenty-Three Tales (1906), public domain in the US. The Bashkirs are a Turkic people of the southern Urals. A widely taught parable; James Joyce reportedly called it the greatest story in world literature. Irony: The answer to the title is a grave. Foreshadowing: Pahóm's dream of the Devil laughing. Structure: A ladder of increasing acquisitions. Watch for land: desire.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I have lost my life, I have lost my life" slowly and put it in my own words: Running to finish the circle before sunset, Pahom fears he has destroyed himself. Next, craft. I notice the repetition, "I have lost my life," said twice in panic. The strongest word is "lost": it means both "wasted" and "will die," and both are true. Then, effect. What does Pahom realize when he cries that he has lost his life? My answer: When Pahom cries that he has lost his life, he realizes that his greed for land has cost him everything; the repetition shows a man realizing too late.

> *I have lost my life, I have lost my life* *(How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I have lost my life, I have lost my life" slowly and put it in my own words: Running to finish the circle before sunset, Pahom fears he has destroyed himself. Next, craft. I notice the repetition, "I have lost my life," said twice in panic. The strongest word is "lost": it means both "wasted" and "will die," and both are true. Then, effect. What does Pahom realize when he cries that he has lost his life? My answer: When Pahom cries that he has lost his life, he realizes that his greed for land has cost him everything; the repetition shows a man realizing too late.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The boast gives the Devil an opening and shows his pride. Ask: How does this line connect to greed? Expected: Each gain brings only dissatisfaction. (The boast.)

> *If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The boast gives the Devil an opening and shows his pride.
Ask: How does this line connect to greed?
Expected answer: Each gain brings only dissatisfaction. (The boast.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for irony, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about greed that grasps more than a person needs? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how How Much Land Does a Man Need? develops the idea of greed that grasps more than a person needs. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. Read in the public-domain translation by Louise Maude and Aylmer Maude.) Exemplar: Pahóm's greed destroys him. When the text says "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8), it shows this directly. He boasts "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself," keeps pushing for more, cries "I have lost my life," and needs only "Six feet."
Task: Annotate the story for irony, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about greed that grasps more than a person needs? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how How Much Land Does a Man Need? develops the idea of greed that grasps more than a person needs. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. Read in the public-domain translation by Louise Maude and Aylmer Maude.)
Exemplar: Pahóm's greed destroys him. When the text says "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8), it shows this directly. He boasts "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself," keeps pushing for more, cries "I have lost my life," and needs only "Six feet."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do you know when you have enough? Ask: where should Pahóm have stopped?
Anchor question: How do you know when you have enough?
Facilitation: Ask: where should Pahóm have stopped?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about greed that grasps more than a person needs? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Pahóm's greed destroys him. ("If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself", How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about greed that grasps more than a person needs? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Pahóm's greed destroys him. ("If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself", How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes greed that grasps more than a person needs. Key takeaway: each gain brings only dissatisfaction.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** The answer to the title is a grave.
- **Foreshadowing:** Pahóm's dream of the Devil laughing.
- **Structure:** A ladder of increasing acquisitions.

Themes and how they develop

- **greed:** each gain brings only dissatisfaction.

Symbols and motifs

- **land:** desire.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8) The boast.
- "I have lost my life, I have lost my life" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120) His realization.
- "Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125) Ending.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Pahóm's greed destroys him.
Evidence: "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8)
Reasoning: He boasts "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself," keeps pushing for more, cries "I have lost my life," and needs only "Six feet."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
haggled (verb)	argued over a price	*Pahóm bargained and haggled with him, and at last they settled the price at 1,500 roubles, part in cash and part to be paid later.*	
disparaged (verb)	spoke of something as having little worth	*The younger sister was piqued, and in turn disparaged the life of a tradesman, and stood up for that of a peasant.*	"disparaged": Origin of "disparage": Old French desparage. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disparage#Etymology)
burdening (verb)	weight down with a load	*She had always lived on good terms with the peasants, until she engaged as her steward an old soldier, who took to burdening the people with fines.*	
freehold (noun)	land owned outright	*The peasants had plenty of land: every man had twenty-five acres of Communal land given him for his use, and any one who had money could buy, besides, at two shillings an acre as much good freehold land as he wanted.*	
glistened (verb)	be shiny, as if wet	*Pahóm's eyes glistened: it was all virgin soil, as flat as the palm of your hand, as black as the seed of a poppy, and in the hollows different kinds of grasses grew breast high.*	"glistened": From Old English glisnian "to gleam," a Germanic word related to glitter and gleam. (Not from Latin tenere.) (Online Etymology Dictionary (hand-checked note), https://www.etymonline.com/word/glisten)
civilly (adverb)	politely, with good manners	*He appealed to them most civilly, but they still went on: now the Communal herdsmen would let the village cows stray into his meadows; then horses from the night pasture would get among his corn.*	"civilly": Origin: an English formation from civil + -ly. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/civilly#Etymology)

carpets (noun)	floor covering consisting of a piece of thick heavy fabric (usually with nap or pile)	*I gave away about one hundred roubles' worth of dressing-gowns and carpets, besides a case of tea, and I gave wine to those who would drink it; and I got the land for less than twopence an acre.*	
assembled (verb)	create by putting components or members together	*The Bashkírs rose and assembled, and the Chief came, too.*	

Discussion questions

1. How do you know when you have enough?
2. Where does irony appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with greed?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who overhears Pahóm's boast? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Devil
2. What do the Bashkirs offer? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: All the land he can walk around in a day
3. What is the price? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A thousand rubles a day
4. What must Pahóm do to keep the land? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Return to the starting point by sunset
5. How much land does Pahóm need in the end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Six feet, for his grave
6. Retell the three most important events of “How Much Land Does a Man Need?” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Peasant Pahóm boasts that with enough land he would fear not even the Devil, who overhears. Pahóm buys land, then more, always wanting more. The Bashkirs offer as much land as he can walk around in a day for a thousand rubles, if he returns by sunset. He walks too far, runs back, reaches the starting point at sunset and falls dead. His servant digs a grave six feet long: all the land he needed.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.

8. Where and when does “How Much Land Does a Man Need?” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “Pahóm bargained and haggled with him, and at last they settled the price at 1,500 roubles, part in cash and part to be paid later.” What does “haggled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: haggled: argued over a price.
10. Reread: “The younger sister was piqued, and in turn disparaged the life of a tradesman, and stood up for that of a peasant.” What does “disparaged” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: disparaged: spoke of something as having little worth.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “How Much Land Does a Man Need?” suggest about greed that grasps more than a person needs? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A widely taught parable; James Joyce reportedly called it the greatest story in world literature.
2. Find one example of irony in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the symbolism in this story shape what we understand about greed that grasps more than a person needs? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8): The boast. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “Close to the village there lived a lady, a small landowner, who had an estate of about three hundred acres.”, why might Tolstoy have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Peasant Pahóm boasts that with enough land he would fear not even the Devil, who overhears. Pahóm buys land, then more, always wanting more. The Bashkirs offer as much land as he can walk around in a day for a thousand rubles, if he returns by sunset. He walks too far, runs back, reaches the…
6. As the opening story, what does “How Much Land Does a Man Need?” set up that the rest of How Much Land Does a Man Need? will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “I have lost my life, I have lost my life” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120): His realization. On structure: A ladder of increasing acquisitions. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “Six feet

from his head to his heels was all he needed" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125): Ending. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: "How do you know when you have enough?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with greed? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8): The boast. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Written 1886. Translation: Louise and Aylmer Maude, Twenty-Three Tales (1906), public domain in the US. The Bashkirs are a Turkic people of the southern Urals. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: "I have lost my life, I have lost my life" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120): His realization. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "A widely taught parable; James Joyce reportedly called it the greatest story in world literature." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: "Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125): Ending. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8): The boast. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about greed that grasps more than a person needs? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: "I have lost my life, I have lost my life" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120): His realization.

Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125): Ending. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to contentment: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Tolstoy need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8): The boast. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “I have lost my life, I have lost my life” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120): His realization. On irony: The answer to the title is a grave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “How Much Land Does a Man Need?” treats greed that grasps more than a person needs with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does How Much Land Does a Man Need? see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125): Ending. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve greed? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8): The boast. On foreshadowing: Pahóm's dream of the Devil laughing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about greed that grasps more than a person needs? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “I have lost my life, I have lost my life” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120): His realization.

Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Leo Tolstoy about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Useful evidence: “Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125): Ending. Theme link: each gain brings only dissatisfaction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the Bashkirs offer?
   A. A herd of horses
   B. All the land he can walk around in a day
   C. A free farm
   D. Gold
   Key: B (All the land he can walk around in a day)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I gave away about one hundred roubles' worth of dressing-gowns and _____, besides a case of tea, and I gave wine to those who would drink it; and I got the land for less than twopence an acre.” Word bank: haggled, burdening, disparaged, carpets
   Key: carpets
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8: “If I had plenty of land, I _____'t fear the Devil himself”
   Key: shouldn
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He appealed to them most _____, but they still went on: now the Communal herdsmen would let the village cows stray into his meadows; then horses from the night pasture would get among his corn.” Word bank: burdening, civilly, haggled, disparaged
   Key: civilly
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The Bashkírs rose and _____, and the Chief came, too.” Word bank: disparaged, burdening, haggled, assembled
   Key: assembled
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Pahóm's eyes _____: it was all virgin soil, as flat as the palm of your hand, as black as the seed of a poppy, and in the hollows different kinds of grasses grew breast high.” Word bank: disparaged, haggled, burdening, glistened
   Key: glistened

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is the price?

   A. Ten rubles an acre

   B. His house

   C. A thousand rubles a day

   D. Nothing

   Key: C (A thousand rubles a day)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125: “Six feet from his head to his heels was all he _____”

   Key: needed

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who overhears Pahóm's boast?

   A. The Devil

   B. His wife

   C. A landlord

   D. A Bashkir

   Key: A (The Devil)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How much land does Pahóm need in the end?

    A. Six feet, for his grave

    B. A hundred acres

    C. The whole steppe

    D. None

    Key: A (Six feet, for his grave)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The boast.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”?

    A. Revenge carried out with perfect control

    B. Wishes that defy fate

    C. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

    D. Confinement driving a woman into madness

    Key: C (Greed that grasps more than a person needs)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I have lost my life, I have lost my life” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His realization.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”? The answer to the title is a grave.

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Simile

    C. Irony

    D. Symbolism

Key: C (Irony)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Ending.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how greed develops from an earlier story to “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: each gain brings only dissatisfaction.
17. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”? Pahóm's dream of the Devil laughing.
    A. Imagery
    B. Foreshadowing
    C. Setting
    D. Hyperbole

    Key: B (Foreshadowing)
18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Pahóm's greed destroys him.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He boasts "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself," keeps pushing for more, cries "I have lost my life," and needs only "Six feet."
19. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8).
    Sample answer: He boasts "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself," keeps pushing for more, cries "I have lost my life," and needs only "Six feet."
20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have lost my life, I have lost my life” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: His realization.
21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What must Pahóm do to keep the land?
    A. Pay tax
    B. Marry a Bashkir
    C. Return to the starting point by sunset
    D. Plant wheat

    Key: C (Return to the starting point by sunset)
22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The boast.
23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She had always lived on good terms with the peasants, until she engaged as her steward an old soldier, who took to burdening the people with fines.”, what does “burdening” most nearly mean?
    A. land owned outright

B. weight down with a load

C. argued over a price

D. spoke of something as having little worth

Key: B (weight down with a load)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The peasants had plenty of land: every man had twenty-five acres of Communal land given him for his use, and any one who had money could buy, besides, at two shillings an acre as much good freehold land as he wanted.", what does "freehold" most nearly mean?

A. spoke of something as having little worth

B. land owned outright

C. argued over a price

D. weight down with a load

Key: B (land owned outright)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The younger sister was piqued, and in turn disparaged the life of a tradesman, and stood up for that of a peasant.", what does "disparaged" most nearly mean?

A. weight down with a load

B. argued over a price

C. spoke of something as having little worth

D. land owned outright

Key: C (spoke of something as having little worth)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Pahóm bargained and haggled with him, and at last they settled the price at 1,500 roubles, part in cash and part to be paid later.", what does "haggled" most nearly mean?

A. weight down with a load

B. spoke of something as having little worth

C. argued over a price

D. land owned outright

Key: C (argued over a price)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 6, 1, 7, 2, 5, 10, 8, 4, 13, 11, 12, 14, 15, 17, 18	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 9, 2, 5, 10, 6, 1, 3, 12, 13, 11, 19, 14, 17, 20, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 21, 6, 2, 9, 8, 5, 11, 13, 12, 19, 14, 15, 17, 20, 16	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	21, 6, 9, 7, 3, 8, 11, 13, 12, 19, 15, 17, 14, 20, 16, 22	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 6, 9, 10, 23, 12, 11, 13, 19, 14, 15, 17, 18, 16, 22, 20	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	24, 4, 1, 5, 23, 13, 12, 11, 15, 19, 17, 14, 22, 20, 16, 18	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 4, 21, 25, 10, 12, 11, 13, 14, 15, 19, 17, 22, 20, 18, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	6, 24, 9, 26, 8, 11, 13, 12, 15, 19, 14, 17, 22, 20, 18, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	10, 8, 25, 3, 2, 11, 13, 12, 17, 14, 15, 19, 20, 18, 22, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Graduate / PhD	6, 1, 8, 24, 9, 12, 13, 11, 15, 14, 19, 17, 16, 20, 22, 18	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “How Much Land Does a Man Need?,” how does Tolstoy show greed that grasps more than a person needs? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In How Much Land Does a Man Need?, how does Tolstoy develop the idea of greed that grasps more than a person needs? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the story helps build that idea. Read in the public-domain translation by Louise Maude and Aylmer Maude.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how How Much Land Does a Man Need? develops the idea of greed that grasps more than a person needs. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. Read in the public-domain translation by Louise Maude and Aylmer Maude.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of How Much Land Does a Man Need? (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of greed that grasps more than a person needs. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what How Much Land Does a Man Need? suggests about greed that grasps more than a person needs. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's irony and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Leo Tolstoy uses irony in How Much Land Does a Man Need? to complicate the reader's understanding of greed that grasps more than a person needs. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate How Much Land Does a Man Need? within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of greed that grasps more than a person needs responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read How Much Land Does a Man Need? alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of greed that grasps more than a person needs follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to How Much Land Does a Man Need? and its treatment of greed that grasps more than a person needs. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's irony and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads How Much Land Does a Man Need? as evidence for a larger claim about greed that grasps more than a person needs in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads How Much Land Does a Man Need? as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of greed that grasps more than a person needs. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on How Much Land Does a Man Need?.

SAT-style questions

1. *She had always lived on good terms with the peasants, until she engaged as her steward an old soldier, who took to burdening the people with fines.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “burdening” most nearly mean?

   A. floor covering consisting of a piece of thick heavy fabric (usually with nap or pile)

   B. weight down with a load

   C. politely, with good manners

   D. create by putting components or members together

2. *Close to the village there lived a lady, a small landowner, who had an estate of about three hundred acres. She had always lived on good terms with the peasants, until she engaged as her steward an old soldier, who took to burdening the people with fines. However careful Pahóm tried to be, it happened again and again that now a horse of his got among the lady's oats, now a cow strayed into her garden, now his calves found their way into her meadows—and he always had to pay a fine.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”?

   A. A family and a house collapsing together

   B. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

   C. Courage and guilt in a small community

   D. Science that poisons love

SAT key: 1. B (weight down with a load); 2. B (Greed that grasps more than a person needs)

Unit test

How Much Land Does a Man Need?: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the Bashkirs offer?

   A. A herd of horses

   B. All the land he can walk around in a day

   C. A free farm

   D. Gold

   Key: B (All the land he can walk around in a day)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I gave away about one hundred roubles' worth of dressing-gowns and _____, besides a case of tea, and I gave wine to those who would drink it; and I got the land for less than twopence an acre.” Word bank: haggled, burdening, disparaged, carpets

   Key: carpets

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How much land does Pahóm need in the end?

   A. Six feet, for his grave

   B. A hundred acres

   C. The whole steppe

   D. None

   Key: A (Six feet, for his grave)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who overhears Pahóm's boast?

   A. The Devil

   B. His wife

   C. A landlord

   D. A Bashkir

   Key: A (The Devil)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8: “If I had plenty of land, I _____'t fear the Devil himself”

   Key: shouldn

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is the price?

   A. Ten rubles an acre

   B. His house

   C. A thousand rubles a day

   D. Nothing

   Key: C (A thousand rubles a day)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Pahóm's eyes _____: it was all virgin soil, as flat as the palm of your hand, as black as the seed of a poppy, and in the hollows different kinds of grasses grew breast high." Word bank: disparaged, haggled, burdening, glistened

   Key: glistened

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He appealed to them most _____, but they still went on: now the Communal herdsmen would let the village cows stray into his meadows; then horses from the night pasture would get among his corn." Word bank: burdening, civilly, haggled, disparaged

   Key: civilly

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What must Pahóm do to keep the land?

   A. Pay tax

   B. Marry a Bashkir

   C. Return to the starting point by sunset

   D. Plant wheat

   Key: C (Return to the starting point by sunset)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The Bashkírs rose and _____, and the Chief came, too." Word bank: disparaged, burdening, haggled, assembled

    Key: assembled

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125: "Six feet from his head to his heels was all he _____"

    Key: needed

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "I have lost my life, I have lost my life" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His realization.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "How Much Land Does a Man Need?"?

    A. Revenge carried out with perfect control

    B. Wishes that defy fate

    C. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

    D. Confinement driving a woman into madness

    Key: C (Greed that grasps more than a person needs)

14. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself" (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The boast.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”? The answer to the title is a grave.

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Simile

    C. Irony

    D. Symbolism

    Key: C (Irony)

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Six feet from his head to his heels was all he needed” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 125). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Ending.

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Pahóm's greed destroys him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8).

    Sample answer: He boasts "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself," keeps pushing for more, cries "I have lost my life," and needs only "Six feet."

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Pahóm's greed destroys him.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He boasts "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself," keeps pushing for more, cries "I have lost my life," and needs only "Six feet."

19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”? Pahóm's dream of the Devil laughing.

    A. Imagery

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Setting

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: B (Foreshadowing)

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how greed develops from an earlier story to “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: each gain brings only dissatisfaction.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The boast.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have lost my life, I have lost my life” (How Much Land Does a Man Need?, paragraph 120) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His realization.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Pahóm bargained and haggled with him, and at last they settled the price at 1,500 roubles, part in cash and part to be paid later.”, what does “haggled” most nearly mean?

    A. weight down with a load

    B. spoke of something as having little worth

C. argued over a price

D. land owned outright

Key: C (argued over a price)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The younger sister was piqued, and in turn disparaged the life of a tradesman, and stood up for that of a peasant.”, what does “disparaged” most nearly mean?

A. weight down with a load

B. argued over a price

C. spoke of something as having little worth

D. land owned outright

Key: C (spoke of something as having little worth)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The peasants had plenty of land: every man had twenty-five acres of Communal land given him for his use, and any one who had money could buy, besides, at two shillings an acre as much good freehold land as he wanted.”, what does “freehold” most nearly mean?

A. spoke of something as having little worth

B. land owned outright

C. argued over a price

D. weight down with a load

Key: B (land owned outright)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She had always lived on good terms with the peasants, until she engaged as her steward an old soldier, who took to burdening the people with fines.”, what does “burdening” most nearly mean?

A. land owned outright

B. weight down with a load

C. argued over a price

D. spoke of something as having little worth

Key: B (weight down with a load)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 11, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 5, 2, 8, 11, 1, 9, 6, 10, 4, 7, 14, 12, 13, 17, 19, 15, 18	recall 11, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 5, 4, 8, 7, 10, 2, 6, 1, 9, 12, 14, 13, 19, 15, 17, 20, 21	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	10, 8, 4, 6, 7, 11, 1, 3, 2, 13, 14, 12, 15, 17, 16, 19, 22, 21	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 6, 2, 11, 3, 4, 7, 8, 13, 14, 12, 15, 16, 19, 17, 21, 22, 20	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	23, 11, 8, 3, 1, 24, 6, 14, 12, 13, 19, 17, 15, 16, 21, 22, 20, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

College Freshman	7, 6, 5, 10, 8, 1, 25, 13, 12, 14, 16, 17, 19, 15, 20, 22, 18, 21	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 8, 24, 1, 25, 6, 26, 14, 12, 13, 15, 16, 17, 19, 18, 21, 20, 22	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	24, 2, 11, 10, 7, 26, 6, 12, 14, 13, 17, 16, 19, 15, 18, 20, 22, 21	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	7, 6, 9, 24, 23, 25, 11, 12, 14, 13, 19, 17, 16, 15, 21, 20, 22, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	7, 25, 6, 8, 9, 1, 23, 13, 14, 12, 19, 17, 15, 16, 18, 22, 20, 21	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Final paper

How Much Land Does a Man Need?: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Leo Tolstoy develops greed across How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in How Much Land Does a Man Need? and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to contentment.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether How Much Land Does a Man Need? finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of the devil's temptation. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Greed

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what How Much Land Does a Man Need? teaches about greed. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Leo Tolstoy develops greed in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Leo Tolstoy develops greed across How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of How Much Land Does a Man Need? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of greed. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of greed in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Leo Tolstoy's choices in How Much Land Does a Man Need? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of greed, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places How Much Land Does a Man Need?'s treatment of greed in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on greed in How Much Land Does a Man Need? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on greed in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about greed in How Much Land Does a Man Need?, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on greed in How Much Land Does a Man Need?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Contentment

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what How Much Land Does a Man Need? teaches about contentment. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Leo Tolstoy develops contentment in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Leo Tolstoy develops contentment across How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of How Much Land Does a Man Need? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of contentment. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of contentment in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Leo Tolstoy's choices in How Much Land Does a Man Need? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of contentment, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places How Much Land Does a Man Need?'s treatment of contentment in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on contentment in How Much Land Does a Man Need? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on contentment in How Much Land Does a Man Need?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The devil's temptation

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what How Much Land Does a Man Need? teaches about the devil's temptation. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Leo Tolstoy develops the devil's temptation in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Leo Tolstoy develops the devil's temptation across How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of How Much Land Does a Man Need? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the devil's temptation. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the devil's temptation in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Leo Tolstoy's choices in How Much Land Does a Man Need? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the devil's temptation, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places How Much Land Does a Man Need?'s treatment of the devil's temptation in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the devil's temptation in How Much Land Does a Man Need? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the devil's temptation in How Much Land Does a Man Need?. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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